PwC Digital Strategy

Evidence Map: Themes and Supporting Interview Evidence

Proposed healthcare acquisition for new-market entry | Draft for discussion | 31 October 2026

1. Basis and evidence scale

The only evidence is the eight interview transcripts, each labelled "Fictional practice transcript created for the hackathon; statements require validation." Everything in this map is therefore stakeholder opinion or request. No statement is independently verified, and no stakeholder reports experience of the target.

Evidence strength is a qualitative judgement of consistency across stakeholders. It is not a statistic, and it is not a measure of importance. No theme is rated above Moderate, because no target-specific or verified evidence exists.

Strength	Meaning
Moderate	Raised consistently by stakeholders in different functions, but still unverified opinion.
Low to moderate	A smaller number of voices, or a general principle with no target-specific content.
Low	Essentially one voice.
Unvalidated	A consultant inference with no direct statement behind it.

Statement IDs (ST-xx) refer to the statement register in the earlier report. Quotes marked "(interview text)" are exact transcript quotes that are not in the register.

2. Summary map

ID	Theme	Stakeholders	Evidence strength
T1	Market size is not market access	S1, S2, S7, S8	Moderate
T2	Management claims need independent verification	S1, S2, S3, S4, S5, S6, S8	Moderate
T3	Advantages may not transfer on change of ownership	S1, S2, S8	Low to moderate
T4	Regulatory and local access steps drive timing and cost	S1, S2, S4, S8	Moderate
T5	Integration could threaten safety and continuity	S3, S5, S7	Low to moderate
T6	Health data, cyber and system integrity	S5 (S2, S6 brief)	Low
T7	Total cost may exceed headline price	S1, S3, S4, S5, S6	Low to moderate
T8	Needs depend on what the target is	S2, S3, S4, S5, S6, S7	Moderate (method only)
T9	Stakeholder decision gates	S1, S3, S4, S6	Low to moderate
T10	Speed rationale vs. constraints	S1 vs S2, S4, S7, S8	Unvalidated

3. Theme evidence maps

T1. A large or growing market does not show the target can capture it

Proposed insight	Demand growth cannot be assumed to convert into revenue or deliverable volume for this target.
Stakeholders	S1, S2, S7, S8
Exact supporting quotes	S1, ST-02: "A broad statement that healthcare demand is growing is not enough to justify this target or its valuation." S2, ST-07: "Market growth does not automatically become revenue for one company." S8, ST-37: "Do not equate a large healthcare market with an accessible market." S7, ST-32: "A market forecast does not tell us whether the target can safely deliver the extra demand."
Evidence strength	Moderate. Four functions (strategy, commercial, country, operations) make the same point from different angles. All are cautions, unverified, and say nothing specific about this target.
Contradictory / alternative evidence	None found. No stakeholder argues that market size alone is sufficient.
Evidence gaps	The target's segments, countries and customers. Actual demand, competitor position and capacity. All are Not established in transcript.
Recommended validation	Build a segment-level, source-traced market and competitor map. Test target capacity against the forecast. Validate with customer references.

T2. Management claims need independent verification

Proposed insight	Stakeholders across functions want original or independently verified records in place of management assertions.
Stakeholders	S1, S2, S3, S4, S5, S6, S8 (S7 is related)
Exact supporting quotes	S1 (interview text): "We should show what we know, what management claims, and what remains untested." S2, ST-08: "rather than relying only on the target's pitch deck." S3, ST-11: "Marketing material and testimonials alone do not establish clinical benefit." S4, ST-17: "We should reconcile management's answers with original records." S5, ST-23: "A policy document alone does not prove controls work." S6, ST-28: "Reconcile reported revenue to contracts, invoices, cash collections and underlying activity." S8, ST-41: "which assumptions are supported by customer evidence rather than management optimism." S7, ST-34 (related): "Definitions and historical trends matter more than a one-off snapshot."
Evidence strength	Moderate. Consistent across most functions. It describes an evidence standard, not a finding about the target.
Contradictory / alternative evidence	None. S7 frames the same need as definitions and trends, not independent verification.
Evidence gaps	What management has claimed is Not established in transcript. No claims or source documents were supplied.
Recommended validation	Build an evidence register that separates verified facts, management claims and untested assumptions. Issue a data request for original records.

T3. Advantages and relationships may not transfer or survive a change of ownership

Proposed insight	The thesis may rely on relationships, reputation and capabilities that are not exclusive, may be personal, or may not move to new markets.
Stakeholders	S1, S2, S8
Exact supporting quotes	S1 (interview text): "the target's reputation and capabilities do not transfer to our intended markets" S1, ST-04: "If the rationale depends on a market-entry advantage that is not exclusive" S2, ST-10: "The team may assume that existing relationships automatically travel across borders or that our current sales force can cross-sell immediately." S8, ST-38: "If relationships depend on one founder or a few individuals, we need to know whether those people will remain and whether the relationships are institutional or personal." S8, ST-40: "Would a change of ownership affect trust, contracts, service, or purchasing decisions?"
Evidence strength	Low to moderate. Three stakeholders agree, but every statement is conditional ("may", "if"). None says the problem exists.
Contradictory / alternative evidence	None direct. S1's "attraction is speed" (ST-01a) assumes some advantage exists, and S1 also says that is "not yet shown" (ST-01b).
Evidence gaps	Contract terms including change of control; customer views; whether key-person dependence exists. All Not established in transcript.
Recommended validation	Review customer contracts and change-of-control clauses. Interview customers and local partners. Map who holds each key relationship.

T4. Regulatory and local access steps determine timing and cost

Proposed insight	Approvals, tenders and other local steps are country-specific and could delay entry. The forecast needs to model them.
Stakeholders	S4, S8, S1, S2
Exact supporting quotes	S4, ST-16: "We must not assume one country's approval works everywhere." S4, ST-19: "The forecast should model the relevant pathway, not simply assume a launch date." S8, ST-39: "Local registration or licensing steps, procurement cycles, reimbursement decisions where applicable, onboarding requirements, customer approvals, language and service expectations, or gaps in local support." S1 (interview text): "required approvals or access channels are uncertain" S2 (interview text): "tender rules, reimbursement or budget constraints"
Evidence strength	Moderate. Four stakeholders in different roles agree. These are general statements, unverified, with no target data.
Contradictory / alternative evidence	Tension, not contradiction (consultant inference): S1 gives "speed" as the attraction. No timeline is stated, so the tension is unvalidated.
Evidence gaps	Target's products, countries, licences, regulator history, and time and cost to obtain missing approvals. Not established in transcript.
Recommended validation	Map licences and approvals by country with legal and regulatory specialists. Compare acquisition, partnership and organic entry timelines.

T5. Integration could threaten patient safety, availability and continuity

Proposed insight	Changes of ownership, suppliers, systems or processes could disrupt safe operation if not controlled.
Stakeholders	S3, S7, S5

Exact supporting quotes	S3, ST-13: "Yes. A change in ownership, supplier, system, service location, or clinical process can affect availability or continuity." S7, ST-35: "Changing suppliers, systems, processes or leadership too quickly can disrupt availability, care workflows, service levels or quality." S5, ST-24: "Poor migration or interoperability can interrupt workflows, make records unavailable, break interfaces, or compromise data integrity."
Evidence strength	Low to moderate. Three stakeholders give consistent warnings, but they are general risk statements. None cites an incident or target-specific dependency.
Contradictory / alternative evidence	None direct. S7's "too quickly" differs from S1's speed emphasis, but S1's speed refers to market entry. That link is a consultant inference and is unvalidated.
Evidence gaps	Critical products and services, dependencies, integration plan, and who can stop an unsafe change. Not established in transcript.
Recommended validation	Build a critical-operations map. Review the integration roadmap and continuity plan. Define what must remain stable.

T6. Health data, cyber and system integrity are a gating exposure

Proposed insight	The target's data practices and cyber controls need examination, and technology or data-protection concerns could affect adoption and cost.
Stakeholders	S5 (primary); S2 and S6 (brief mentions)
Exact supporting quotes	S5, ST-23: "A policy document alone does not prove controls work." S5, ST-22: "What personal or health data is collected, why it is used, where it is stored, …" S2 (interview text): "clinicians and data-protection teams can still block implementation" S6 (interview text): "technology and cyber upgrades"
Evidence strength	Low. One stakeholder develops this in depth, and the other two mention it in passing. This reflects the transcripts' coverage, not importance.
Contradictory / alternative evidence	None.
Evidence gaps	Whether the target holds health data, its system inventory, breach history and test results. Not established in transcript.
Recommended validation	Request a data-flow and system inventory, penetration-test results and incident history. Obtain a technical review.

T7. Total acquisition cost may exceed the headline price

Proposed insight	Remediation, technology, integration and working-capital costs may be missing from the headline valuation and need quantifying.
Stakeholders	S6, S3, S4, S5, S1
Exact supporting quotes	S6, ST-29: "liabilities that are not obvious from the headline valuation." S3, ST-15: "uncosted remediation plan" S4, ST-20: "a remediation requirement with no credible owner, cost, or timeline" S5, ST-26: "Cyber remediation, licence and vendor costs, data migration, interoperability, …" S6, ST-30: "The team should show the impact on cash flow and returns rather than just describe risks." S1 (interview text): "a downside case"
Evidence strength	Low to moderate. Several functions point to costs, but all speak in conditionals. ST-29 is classed ambiguous in the classification review.
Contradictory / alternative evidence	None. No stakeholder reports that a remediation need or hidden liability exists.

Evidence gaps	Valuation, financials, any quantified cost. Not established in transcript.
Recommended validation	Commission independent quality-of-earnings work. Cost remediation items after quality, regulatory and cyber reviews. Build downside cases in the model.

T8. Most risk and evidence needs depend on what the target actually is

Proposed insight	Until the target's business model, countries and products are known, risks and evidence needs cannot be specified or prioritised.
Stakeholders	S2, S3, S4, S5, S6, S7
Exact supporting quotes	S2 (interview text): "That depends on the business model." S6 (interview text): "That depends on the target." S3 (interview text): "The precise list depends on what the target actually does." S4 (interview text): "First, list the target's actual products and services and every country in which it operates or plans to enter."
Evidence strength	Moderate as a statement about method, since the stakeholders agree. It says nothing about the target itself.
Contradictory / alternative evidence	None.
Evidence gaps	Target identity, business model, countries and products. Not established in transcript.
Recommended validation	Obtain the target's business description and product/country list before the next evidence request.

T9. Stakeholders set conditions for pausing, escalating or qualifying the decision

Proposed insight	Four stakeholders hold distinct decision gates, and there is no agreed shared framework.
Stakeholders	S1, S3, S4, S6
Exact supporting quotes	S1 (interview text): "I would also pause if we cannot explain why acquisition is better than partnership or organic entry." S3, ST-15: "should be escalated before commitment" S4 (interview text): "These issues need legal and regulatory review before the team recommends proceeding." S6, ST-31: "If critical assumptions cannot be validated, the recommendation may need to be conditional or the decision paused."
Evidence strength	Low to moderate. The gates are stated clearly, but their relationship and thresholds are not.
Contradictory / alternative evidence	Difference in framing: S6 allows a "conditional" outcome, while S1, S3 and S4 describe pausing or escalating. This may reflect different roles and is unvalidated as a disagreement.
Evidence gaps	Whether any gate currently applies. The client's investment thresholds. Not established in transcript.
Recommended validation	Agree a single decision-gate framework with the client, and record the thresholds.

T10. The speed rationale conflicts with approval and integration constraints (UNVALIDATED)

Proposed insight	Speed may not materialise if approvals, tenders and integration constraints delay benefits.
Stakeholders	S1 against S2, S4, S7, S8
Exact supporting	S1, ST-01a: "The attraction is speed."

quotes	Counterpoints are in T4 and T5. No stakeholder links the two statements.
Evidence strength	Unvalidated. This is a consultant inference from comparing separate statements. No interviewee says speed is at risk, and no timelines are given.
Contradictory / alternative evidence	S1's "speed" refers to entry, while S4, S7 and S8 refer to timing, and they may not conflict at all.
Evidence gaps	Timelines for acquisition, partnership and organic entry. Not established in transcript.
Recommended validation	Build a comparative timeline for the three entry routes before treating speed as an advantage.

4. Conclusions the transcripts do not support

The following are all unvalidated.

- That acquisition is better than partnership or organic entry. S1 states this has not been shown.
- That the target has any exclusive advantage, strong quality record, valid licences or sound finances.
- That any red flag or gate trigger currently applies.
- That any theme is more important than another. The themes are not ranked, and the number of stakeholders raising one is not a measure of importance.
- That any figure, date or amount is known. The transcripts contain none.

5. Priority validation actions

1. Obtain the target's business model, countries and products (T8). Most other checks depend on this.
2. Issue a data request for original records covering regulatory, quality, contract, data and financial areas (T2, T3, T4, T6, T7).
3. Interview the people the interviewees named as missing: target management, customers, local partners, independent quality reviewers and legal specialists.
4. Agree a shared decision-gate framework and client thresholds (T9).
5. Build a comparative timeline of the three entry routes (T4, T10).